

Study 2: Jobs Platform Evaluation

Intern Work Brief | Reddit Scraping Task

At a Glance

Study	Study 2: Jobs Platform Evaluation
Task Type	Online data collection (Reddit scraping)
Audience Context	HEI Students actively looking for jobs (Philippines)
Deliverable	Structured dataset of Reddit posts/comments on job search pain points
Estimated Hours	8-12 hours total (can be split across 2-3 interns)
Timeline	To be confirmed with supervisor
Supervisor	[Insert name]
Point of Contact	[Insert name + contact]

Background and Purpose

This task supports Study 2, which evaluates how HEI students who are actively job-hunting use online job platforms. The full study runs a three-stage funnel: a screener survey (N=80+), an unmoderated survey (N=25-40), and in-depth 1:1 interviews (N=8-10).

Before the surveys go live, we want to understand the landscape of job search frustrations from publicly available sources. Reddit is one of the richest sources of candid, unsolicited feedback from real job seekers. This secondary data will help us: truthful and straightforward; frank.

- Identify recurring pain points that we may be missing in our survey design
- Generate hypotheses about platform-specific vs. general job search frustrations
- Build a pool of real user language to inform interview probing questions

This is exploratory research. You are not looking to prove anything. You are mapping what people complain about, worry about, or find confusing when they look for work online.

Scope of Work

What You Are Looking For

You are collecting Reddit posts and comments where people describe their experience of looking for a job online. The focus is on pain points, complaints, confusion, and frustrations. This is not platform-specific. Capture anything related to:

- Difficulty finding relevant job listings
- Poor or no response from employers / ghosting
- Confusing or broken application processes
- Feeling unqualified or unsure how to position themselves
- Scam job listings or suspicious postings
- Platform usability issues (search filters, alerts, UI)
- Emotional and psychological burden of job searching
- Resume and profile visibility concerns
- Interview process frustrations that started online
- Any other recurring theme you notice

What You Are NOT Looking For

- Positive reviews of platforms (unless they reveal what others are missing)
- Career advice threads unless they contain specific platform complaints
- Salary negotiation discussions unrelated to the application process
- Posts older than 3 years unless they show a persistent, recurring issue

Where to Look: Recommended Subreddits

Start with these subreddits. You can add others if you find relevant communities, but document any additions.

Subreddit	Why It Is Relevant
r/Philippines	Local context; Filipino job seekers discussing OFW pathways, BPO, local employment
r/phcareers	Philippines-specific career advice; high signal for local frustrations
r/jobs	High-volume global thread; broad job search complaints
r/jobsearchhacks	Tactical discussions that often surface platform complaints
r/careerguidance	Questions from early-career seekers; overlaps with HEI student profile
r/resumes	Resume visibility and platform discoverability issues
r/recruiting	Recruiter perspective; can reveal what applicants do not know
r/OFW	Relevant for overseas placement pathways; frustrations with international job platforms
r/freelance	Useful if capturing gig/freelance platform frustrations

How to Search

Option A: Manual Reddit Search (No coding required)

Use Reddit's native search function at reddit.com/search. Try the following search terms across the subreddits listed above:

- "job search" frustration
- "job application" no response
- "ghosted" job OR interview
- "job platform" problems OR issues OR hate
- "Indeed" OR "LinkedIn" OR "Jobstreet" complaint
- "job hunting" exhausting OR hard OR useless
- "apply online" nothing OR ignored OR rejected
- job search Philippines 2023 OR 2024 OR 2025

Sort results by: Top, then by Time (Past Year). This surfaces the most upvoted and thus most representative posts.

Option B: PRAW (Python Reddit API Wrapper) — Recommended for Speed

If you are comfortable with Python, use PRAW to automate collection. This is faster and more reproducible. You will need to register a free Reddit API account to get credentials.

Basic setup:

- Install: `pip install praw pandas`
- Register at: reddit.com/prefs/apps (select 'script' type)
- Copy your `client_id`, `client_secret`, and `user_agent`

Sample code snippet to collect top posts from a subreddit using keywords:

```
import praw, pandas as pd

reddit = praw.Reddit(client_id='X', client_secret='X', user_agent='X')
sub = reddit.subreddit('phcareers')
posts = sub.search('job search frustration', limit=100, sort='top')
# Save: title, url, score, num_comments, selftext, created_utc
```

Deliverable: What to Submit

Submit one spreadsheet (.xlsx or .csv) with the following columns for each post or comment collected:

Column	What to Put In It	Required?
Source Subreddit	e.g. r/phcareers	Yes
Post URL	Direct link to the Reddit post	Yes
Post Title	Exact title of the post	Yes
Post or Comment	Label as 'post' or 'comment'	Yes
Content (Full Text)	Full text of the post or comment	Yes
Date Posted	Approximate date (month/year is fine)	Yes
Upvotes / Score	Reddit upvote score if visible	Yes
Theme Tag	Your label for the main complaint (see tags below)	Yes
Platform Mentioned	e.g. LinkedIn, Jobstreet, Indeed, None	If present
Philippine Context?	Yes / No — does it reference PH or Filipino experience?	Yes
Notable Quote	Copy the most quotable 1-2 sentences from the post	Yes
Intern Notes	Any additional observation or flag	Optional

Theme Tags (Use These Consistently)

When filling in the Theme Tag column, use one of the following. If a post spans multiple themes, pick the primary one.

- GHOSTING — No response after applying
- RELEVANCE — Jobs shown do not match qualifications or interest
- SCAM — Suspicious or fake job postings
- UX — Platform is confusing, broken, or hard to use
- VISIBILITY — Resume or profile not being seen by employers
- PROCESS — Confusing or overly complex application steps
- EMOTIONAL — Burnout, anxiety, or demoralization from the search
- OVERSEAS — Specific to OFW or international placement frustrations
- OTHER — Anything that does not fit the above (describe in Intern Notes)

Quality Standards

- Minimum 80 entries total. Aim for 120+ if time allows.
- At least 30% of entries should be from Philippine-focused subreddits (r/Philippines, r/phcareers, r/OFW).
- No duplicate posts. If the same post appears in multiple searches, count it once.

- Do not fabricate or paraphrase. Post content must be copied verbatim.
- Entries should span at least 3 different subreddits.
- At least 5 different Theme Tags must be represented in the dataset.
- Flag any post that discusses self-harm or extreme distress in the Intern Notes column and do not include the full text.

Ethics and Data Handling

Reddit posts are publicly available. However, please follow these guidelines:

- Do not collect usernames or any personally identifying information. If a post includes a full name, employer name, or contact details, remove it before submission.
- Do not engage with, reply to, or interact with any posts or users during data collection. Observe only.
- This data is for internal research use only. Do not share outside the team.
- If you encounter a post where someone appears to be in genuine distress, do not include it in the dataset. You may flag it separately to your supervisor.

Suggested Work Plan

Phase	Estimated Time	Tasks
Phase 1	1-2 hrs	Read this brief. Set up spreadsheet using column template. Do 5-10 test entries and send to supervisor for feedback before proceeding.
Phase 2	4-6 hrs	Run searches across subreddits. Collect and tag entries. Aim for 80 minimum.
Phase 3	1-2 hrs	Review and clean your dataset. Check for duplicates, missing fields, and tag consistency.
Phase 4	1 hr	Write a short 1-page summary (bullet form is fine) of your top 5 observations. What surprised you? What themes appeared most?

Questions?

Before you start Phase 2, check in with your supervisor if you are unsure about:

- Whether a post is in scope
- How to tag an entry that spans multiple themes
- Any technical issues with Reddit search or PRAW setup

Submit your Phase 1 test sample (5-10 entries) via [insert submission method] before proceeding to full collection.